Algorithmic Futures Trading Plan

Business report: strategy, funding model, roadmap and risk

NQ / MNQ and MCL futures | MultiCharts automation | Apex Trader Funding

October 30, 2026 (version 3; v2: October 24, v1: October 16)

In one sentence

Use prop-firm accounts as a low-cost live test bench and funding source for a diversified, backtested set of automated futures strategies; scale to Apex's 20-account limit once the edge is confirmed live, and channel payouts into a personal trading account where proven strategies can grow without payout caps.

All performance figures are backtests (2018-2026) and simulations, not guarantees. Live results are expected to be lower.

What changed since the October 24 version (v3)

Area	October 24 (v2)	October 30 (v3)
Live accounts	#1 and #2 50K live; #3 150K planned	#1 blew 10/26 and #3 (150K) blew 10/30, each on one full stop at a thin cushion; #2 (50K) live with ~$1,070 of room. Thin-cushion test: skipping trades never beat the full set
Account buying	Ramp +2 150Ks a week after the mid-December gate	No new 50Ks. Job-funded buying from Nov 1: 3-4 150K No-Activation a week to Dec 24 (~6-8 funded by Dec 31)
50K funded plan	10 strategies	11: VB 1/1 + Swing Target 1 (10/25); Overnight Tick 1 for the Monday Long (10/24); T_ONESIDE fade 1 for the Relative Strength longs (10/28)
150K funded plan	x 1.5 + RS 1 + Dual Thrust 2	x 1.5 + RS 1 + Overnight Tick 2 + Swing Target 2 (in Dual Thrust's slot)
Personal account	17 pieces	19 pieces (+ Swing Target, PAPERTREND); ~$41.5k a year at 1 micro, needs ~$36k
Live guard	Trade logger + VPS push	Watchdog alarms to the phone, strategy heartbeat, chart monitor, pre-market check, live dashboard
Outlook	-	**2027 outlook (section 4):** ~$100k from Apex at 75% edge (median); ~$170k if the job continues*; nothing funded by Dec 31 in 14-28% of histories

* see the footnote under '2027 outlook' in section 4. The rest of the report is version 2, carried over.

What changed since the October 16 version

Area	October 16 (v1)	October 24 (v2)
Live accounts	#1 50K EOD live since 10/12; #2 planned 10/20; #3 150K ~10/27	#1 $49,899 (~$398 above its trailing line), #2 $49,424 (live since 10/20); #3 150K still ~10/27. First Apex daily-loss lock (10/19) and a symbol-mapping rejection (10/20) found and fixed
50K evaluation set	VB 8, ONB ADX30 $1,100, Bridge 2, EOS $500	Unchanged (pass rate 50.1%; 49.8% at real micro fees)
50K funded plan	8 strategies (VB 3 / 1)	10 strategies: + ES MOC Follow 2 MES, + Relative Strength longs 1 MNQ; VB 2 / 1
150K funded plan	Funded set x 1.5	Funded set x 1.5 + Relative Strength both sides 1 MNQ + **Dual Thrust 2 MNQ** (all 6 payouts ~24 days sooner in the bootstrap)
Personal account	The plan at 1/10 size (MNQ) from ~$10k; full 1-NQ size at ~$100k	Its own 17-piece portfolio and a capital ladder: starter sets from ~$11k, the 16-piece core at ~$26k, S30 weighted by account size, 1 mini per piece at ~$265k (section 4)
Research	Over 200 ideas ranked	~300 ranked; new A: FC 2B, Dual Thrust; a forward log (paper tracking) for FC 2B, S47 v2, Kusho v9, S30; a second AI builder (Codex) with a weekly cross-review
Costs	$7.25 per NQ + 1 tick	Same, checked against real Apex micro fees (~$1.04 a round trip): plan payouts -$96 over 2 years, no decision changes

Sections 3 and 4 (Apex rules, account choice, projections) are carried over from version 1 unchanged; they were not re-run for the 10-strategy funded plan.

1. Executive summary

The business runs a portfolio of eight automated futures strategies on proprietary-trading ("prop") accounts at Apex Trader Funding. Prop accounts let us trade with the firm's capital: our only cost is the evaluation and activation fees, while profits are paid out up to a fixed cap per account. The plan has three stages: **prove** the edge live on a few accounts, **scale** to Apex's 20-account limit, and **compound** payouts in a personal account that has no payout cap.

Key figure	Value	What it means
Strategy edge (backtest, 1 NQ each)	~$101k / year, Sharpe 2.75	Max drawdown $24k; 19% of months lose money (v1 figure, 8-strategy plan)
Personal portfolio (v2, 1 micro per piece)	$36.6k / year, Sharpe 2.96 (17 pieces)	16-piece core $30.6k, Sharpe 3.17, needs ~$26k; 1 mini per piece ~$317k / year on ~$265k
Share of profit that is real skill	92% (alpha t-stat 7.1)	Only 8% comes from simply being long NQ
Evaluation pass rate	50% (50K) / 42% (150K)	Zero-skill baseline is ~40%
Payout per funded account	$12.5k (50K) / $19.7k (150K)	Within 2 years; blown 3% / 0%
Value per account slot, 3 years	$34.8k (50K) / $52.8k (150K)	Net of all fees
Year-1 outlook (ramp to 20, mostly 150K)	~+$182k; ~$1.03M over 3 years	Backtest-based; ~$99k / $747k if live keeps 75% of the edge
Evaluation budget for the scale-up	~$20k set aside	Fees paid before payouts catch up; up to ~$35k if the edge is weaker
Cost of testing the edge live	~$400-800	If it fails, we stop after Phase 1
First payouts expected	~mid-to-late February 2027	Range: January to April+

Recommendation, in priority order. (1) **Prove the edge live**: accounts #1-#2 on **50K EOD** ($59 each), #3 as a **150K No-Activation** ($249) to test the 150K setup early; pass the live check (~40-70 trades at 75%+ of backtest). (2) **Scale Apex**: with ~$20k set aside for evaluation fees, add 150K No-Activation accounts two per week to 20. (3) **Open the personal account from the first payouts** (~$11k starter set, around February), not from savings, and grow it along the capital ladder (section 4); per dollar, Apex evaluations earn far more in year 1 than a small personal account.

2. The strategy portfolio

Every strategy is automated in MultiCharts, trades Nasdaq-100 futures (MNQ) or crude oil (MCL), and is flat by 15:59 CT. Each was backtested 2018-2026 with realistic costs ($7.25 commission plus one tick of slippage per fill), confirmed trade-by-trade in MultiCharts, and ranked on a quality scale from S+ (best) to F.

Strategy	Idea in plain terms	Rank	Role
Overnight Bias ML	Trades the morning in the direction the overnight session leaned, filtered by a model	S	Biggest payout driver
Vault Break	Buys / sells breakouts of the day's 'noise band'; wins ~66% of trades	A	Engine of the evaluation; funded core
Bridge Monday Long	Holds a long from Sunday evening into Monday in uptrends	A	Uncorrelated Monday drift
Monday Long	Our own Monday long with a different trigger	A	Uncorrelated
Late-Day Flow	Follows strong moves into the last hour (ETF rebalancing flows)	A	Afternoon diversifier
Expiration Open Short	Short on monthly options-expiration mornings (dealer hedging)	A	Forced-flow event
CL Sunday Gap Fade	Fades crude oil's Sunday-open gap-ups (weekend overreaction)	A	Different market; cuts blow-ups
NFP Fade	Fades the jobs-report spike	B	Small, event-based
ES MOC Follow (v2)	Follows the S&P;'s pre-close move into the closing auction	B	50K / 150K funded, 2-3 MES
Relative Strength (v2)	Follows NQ's 9:00 move beyond its ES beta	B	Funded longs (50K) / both sides (150K)
Dual Thrust (v2)	Breakout of the open by half the prior day's range	A	150K funded 2 MNQ; personal

The personal portfolio adds personal-only pieces that Apex can't hold (overnight / multi-day) or that don't help an Apex plan: Twin Continuation, FC 2B, Overnight Anomaly, Kusho v9, S47 v2 and S30 IBS (section 4).

Why it should keep working. The strategies are built around repeatable market mechanics (overnight positioning, forced fund flows, options expiration, weekend gaps) rather than chart patterns. They have near-zero correlation with each other, and the combined plan is positive in both 2018-22 and 2023-26.

Quality controls applied to every strategy: realistic costs; random-direction placebo; results split by year and by long / short; multiple-testing correction (deflated Sharpe ratio); an independent re-implementation by a separate checker; and a regression showing the profit is not just market drift.

3. Funding model: Apex Trader Funding

An Apex account starts with an **evaluation**: reach a profit target within 30 days without breaching a trailing drawdown. Passing unlocks a **Performance Account (PA)** that pays out up to six times, then closes. A new evaluation replaces it. Up to 20 accounts can run at once.

Rule	50K account	150K account
Evaluation profit target	$3,000	$9,000
Max drawdown (end-of-day trailing)	$2,000	$4,000
Daily loss limit (pauses the day)	$1,000	$2,000
Max contracts	6 mini / 60 micro	12 mini / 120 micro
Payout ladder (6 payouts, then closes)	1,500 / 1,500 / 2,000 / 2,500 / 2,500 / 3,000 = $13,000	2,500 / 3,000 / 3,000 / 3,000 / 4,000 / 5,000 = $20,500
Payout conditions	5 days of $250+, balance $52,600+, 50% consistency	5 days of $350+, balance $154,600+, 50% consistency

Source: Apex pricing and rules pages (screenshots in the repository, October 15, 2026).

Choosing the account type

Each size comes with or without an activation fee. Trading rules and payouts are identical; only the cost differs. Because some evaluations fail, the real cost is: evaluation price x tries needed + activation fee.

Rank	Account type	Price	Cost per funded account	Net per slot over 3 years
1	150K No-Activation	$249	$598	$52,788
2	150K EOD, 5-pack	$199 + $150 activation	$628	$52,682
3	150K EOD, single	$219 + $150 activation	$676	$52,525
4	50K EOD, 5-pack (most cost-efficient)	$24.50 + $130 activation	$179	$34,813
5	50K No-Activation, 5-pack	$109	$218	$34,751
6	50K No-Activation, single	$119	$238	$34,690
7	50K EOD, single	$59 + $130 activation	$248	$34,604

- **Test phase:** single 50K EOD ($59 + $130 activation on a pass, ~$248 per funded account). The 5-pack is cheaper ($179) but all five evaluations start the day of purchase, so they trade identical days on the copier and pass or fail together: one bet placed five times. Singles keep accounts 5-10 trading days apart.
- **Scale phase:** 150K No-Activation. Each slot earns ~$18k more over 3 years; with a 20-account cap that is what counts.
- **Speed:** 50K reaches its first payout ~2 weeks sooner (median 87 vs 95 trading days); 150K pays ~50% more.
- Fees are only 2-4% of payouts on every path, so account size matters far more than the fee option.

4. Financial projections

Simulated on real market history (start dates 2018-2023, three-year windows), with every account running the plan through the exact Apex rules. These are backtest-based; Section 7 shows a weaker-edge case.

Single funded account (10/16 plan; the current 150K plan: ~$18.1k year 1 / ~$20.3k in 2 years, bootstrapped)

	50K (current sizing)	150K (plan x 1.5)
Payouts within 1 year	$10,184	$15,731
Payouts within 2 years	$12,450 (cap $13,000)	$19,743 (cap $20,500)
Accounts blown	3%	0%
All 6 payouts within 2 years	94%	91%

Three accounts: the first year month by month (10/16 plan, for reference)

After	Typical (median)	Bad case (10th pct)	Good case (90th pct)	Any payout received
1 month	-$400	-$520	-$250	1%
3 months	-$455	-$755	+$5,595	36%
6 months	+$4,045	-$705	+$19,385	71%
12 months	+$29,345	+$3,455	+$38,110	96%

Month 1 is fees only: evaluations pass in about 6 trading days, but Apex payouts need the balance built up first, so the first payout usually arrives in month 2-4.

Scaling: the agreed plan of October 30 (budget-driven, new in v3)

Simulated (analysis/ramp_budget_test.py): from Mon Nov 2, every paycheck ($25 x 8 h, 5 or 6 days, after tax) and every payout buys 150K No-Activation evaluations ($249), up to 20 open accounts; failed evaluations and finished funded accounts free their place. Every 10th start day 2018-2023 in real day order. Funded payouts use the 10/16 plan x 1.5, ~15% below the current 150K plan, so payouts are on the low side. #2 (50K) is not included.

Scenario	Evaluations to Dec 31	Funded Dec 31 (p10-median-p90)	No funded at all by Dec 31	First payout (median)	2027 payouts (p10 / median / p90)
Job to Dec 24, 5 days, 1 buy a day (backtest edge)	23	0 - 6 - 14	14%	late Feb	$0 / $246k / $405k
Job to Dec 24, 6 days, 1 buy a day	28	0 - 8 - 17	13%	late Feb	$0 / $264k / $410k
Job kept in 2027*, 5 days, 1 buy a day	23	0 - 6 - 14	14%	early Mar	$8k / $307k / $414k
Job to Dec 24, 5 days, **75% of the edge**	23	0 - 3 - 12	28%	late Mar	$0 / $96k / $289k
Job kept in 2027*, 5 days, **75% of the edge**	23	0 - 3 - 12	28%	late Mar	$0 / $171k / $320k

- **Same-day buys are one bet:** every account trades the same signals, so evaluations started the same day pass or fail together. Buying one a day instead of all on payday cut the chance of no funded account by Dec 31 from 16% to 14% (backtest) and 33% to 28% (75% edge) for a small cost in the median.
- **The main risk:** a bad 2-month stretch fails every evaluation (14-28% of histories). If the job has ended, the money is gone and 2027 pays $0; with the job, buying continues. Keep a small reserve and stop at the drift alarm.

- The October 16 schedule (+2 x 150K a week from month 2; 12 months $182k backtest / $99k at 75%) is superseded.

Personal account (Phase 3 onward): the capital ladder (new in v2)

No Apex rules: overnight holds allowed, no trailing limit, no payout cap. The portfolio has 17 pieces: the 10 funded strategies (Relative Strength both sides) plus Twin Continuation, FC 2B, Overnight Anomaly, Dual Thrust, Kusho v9, S47 v2 and S30 IBS (NQ + ES). Capital is set so the 1-year Monte Carlo 95th-percentile drawdown is at most 20% of the account (Davey / Radge sizing). Figures are backtests 2018-2026 after costs (micro commissions ~$1.25 a round trip).

Account	Setup (1 micro = 1 MNQ / MES / MCL)	$ a year (median)	Bad year (5th pct)	Drawdown (95th pct)
~$11k	Starter set A: Twin, ONB ML, Bridge, CL Sunday, NFP (B: + EOS)	$8.2k	$3.2k	$2.3k
~$13.6k	Set C: B + Vault Break	$10.5k	$4.5k	$2.7k
~$20.4k	Set D: C + Relative Strength + ES MOC	$14.6k	$6.3k	$4.1k
~$26.2k	**Core: the 16 pieces without S30**, 1 micro each	$29.9k	$16.4k	$5.2k
~$35.6k	Core + S30 at 1 micro (same weight)	$35.7k	$19.4k	$7.1k
~$55.7k	Core x 2 + S30 at 1 micro (half weight)	$65.7k	$36.7k	$11.1k
~$105k	**Core x 4 + S30 at 1 micro (quarter weight: the best mix)**	$125.8k	$69.7k	$21.1k
~$265k	Core x 10 = 1 mini (NQ / ES / CL) per piece + S30 at 3 MNQ + 3 MES	$317.2k	$176.8k	$53.1k

- **Units:** each row's '$ a year' is at that row's size. The core at 1 micro is ~$2,500 a month; at 1 mini per piece ~$25,000 a month, with drawdowns 10 times as large.
- **S30's weight:** at full weight it lowers return per risk (Sharpe 3.17 to 2.96, return / drawdown 9.2 to 7.7); at a quarter to half of the other pieces' size it raises it (quarter: Sharpe 3.21, return / drawdown 9.4), because it barely moves with them (correlation +0.11). Full weight only between ~$35.6k and ~$55.7k.
- **Minis** mostly lower costs (1 NQ ~$4-5 commission vs ~$10-12 for 10 MNQ, very roughly +3%); micros and minis mix freely (1 NQ + 3 MNQ = 13 micros).
- **Step rule:** move up a row only when the account reaches it; step back down after a 20% drawdown.
- **Live expectation:** in-sample backtests; we expect live results of at least 75% of them (the 1-mini row ~$240k a year at 75%, ~$190k at 60%). Kusho v9, S47 v2, S30 and FC 2B are also on the forward log (paper tracking).

Version 1 for comparison: the 8-strategy plan at 1 NQ each made ~$101k a year with a $24k drawdown and needed ~$100k; start at 1/10 size from ~$10k.

2027 outlook (new in v3, 2026-10-30)

Status 10/30: #1 (50K) blew 10/26 and #3 (150K) blew 10/30, both on one full stop at a thin cushion (normal at ~50% / ~56% evaluation fail rates; skipping trades on a thin cushion tested worse). #2 (50K) is live with ~$1,070 of room. No new 50Ks; every new account is a 150K No-Activation ($249).

Funding	Buying Nov 1 - Dec 24	Funded 150Ks Dec 31	Late Jan	2027 from Apex (backtest / 75% edge)
Job pay to Dec 24 only	pay + payouts -> evaluations, 1 a day (~23-28 by Dec 31)	~6-8	~10-13	~$250k / ~$100k
Job kept through 2027*	same, and the job keeps buying in 2027 (20-account cap)	~6-8	~12	~$310k / ~$170k

- **First payouts ~late February - March 2027** (each 150K needs +$5,600 and 5 days of $350+ before payout 1; January at the earliest). Budget January - February with no trading income.

- Medians from the budget simulation above (payouts re-invested into evaluations). Every account trades the same plan: in 14-28% of histories nothing is funded by Dec 31, and without the job 2027 can then pay $0.
- **Personal account:** opened once Apex reaches its account cap and pays for its own replacements (~March with the job, later without it), funded from the job and part of the payouts; starter set A at ~$11.5k (~April - May), core 16 at ~$26k (~summer), contributing ~$5-10k in 2027.
- Stop buying if the drift alarm fires; the mid-December gate (~40-70 live trades at >= 75% of backtest) decides the ramp.

* Assumes the $25 / hour job (8 hours, 5-6 days a week, ~$850-1,000 a week after tax) continues through 2027 and all of it goes to evaluations until ~February, then to the personal account. With the job's ~$44k after tax, 2027 is ~$215k all-in at 75% of the backtest edge (Apex median ~$170k). Not a promise: backtest-based, live edge not yet confirmed.

5. Roadmap

Phase	Timing	Actions	Gate to move on
1. Prove	Now to ~week 8	#1 50K EOD (live since 10/12), #2 50K EOD Tue 10/20, #3 150K No-Activation ~10/27 (tests the 150K setup). Single evaluations, 5-10 trading days apart (5-pack evaluations all start at purchase). Weekly MultiCharts reports for live-vs-backtest tracking.	~40-70 live trades, live average at least 75% of backtest, no drift alarm
2. Scale	~Month 2-5	~$20k evaluation budget set aside. Add 150K No-Activation accounts, 2 per week, to 20 total. 50K slots keep cycling until their first funded account pays all 6 payouts ($13,000) or blows, then switch to 150K. Four copier masters (50K / 150K x evaluation / funded).	Live edge holds; cumulative cash above -$20k
3. Personal account	From the first payouts (~Feb 2027)	Open with ~$11k from Apex payouts (not savings): starter set A / B, then C, D and the 16-piece core (~$26k) as the balance grows (section 4 ladder).	6-12 months of live results matching backtest
4. Grow	Month 6-12+	Personal account up the ladder: core x 4 + S30 at quarter weight (~$105k), then 1 mini per piece (~$265k); promote live-confirmed strategies to S+; new strategies enter through the lifecycle below.	Ongoing monitoring

Strategy lifecycle (how new strategies are added)

Stage	Where	Gate
1. Research	Python backtest 2018-2026	Passes the multiple-testing bar, beats a random-direction placebo, positive in both 2018-22 and 2023-26
2. Confirmation	MultiCharts + independent checker	MultiCharts trades match the research version; checker passes it
3. Apex incubation	Smallest size, on accounts running the full plan	~40 live trades at 75%+ of backtest, no drift alarm, no rise in blow-ups
4. Live	Personal account	Sized so the worst drawdown is 20-30% of the account

Demotion: a first drift alarm halves the strategy's size; a second alarm or a live average below half the backtest sends it back to incubation or retirement.

6. Quality ranking and governance

Rank	Meaning
S+	Meets every S requirement and is confirmed in live trading (40+ live trades at 75%+ of backtest). Empty today; Overnight Bias ML is first in line.
S	Extreme profit and edge: ~$20k+ a year per NQ, t-stat 4.5+, profit factor 2+, 8 of 9 years positive, scalable.
A	Very strong: t 2.5+, profit factor 1.4+, 7+ of 9 years positive, MultiCharts-confirmed.
B / C	Real but smaller, or regime-dependent edges.
D / F	Weak after costs, or no edge. Over 200 ideas tested; most end here.

- **Live monitoring:** weekly reports feed a drift alarm per strategy (OK / WATCH / ALARM).
- **Operations:** an always-on machine (no sleep or forced updates), one copier master per account type and phase, and an error log of every MultiCharts issue solved.
- **Compliance:** every account runs the full plan on one symbol per market, so positions net within an account and never oppose each other across accounts (cross-account hedging is prohibited by Apex).

7. Risks and mitigations

Risk	What could happen	Mitigation
Backtest overstates the edge	Strategies were selected on the same history they are tested on; live results are typically lower	Phase-1 gate before scaling; multiple-testing correction; independent checker; drift alarm
Weaker live edge (75% case)	Year 1 ~$99k with the 150K ramp, but the bad case is about -$32k and up to ~$37k of fees go out before payouts	Scale only after the gate; ~$20k evaluation budget; pause new accounts below -$20k cumulative; half size on any ALARM
Correlated accounts	All accounts trade the same signals, so a bad month hits all of them together	Stagger account starts 5-10 trading days apart; gradual ramp
Prop-firm rule or payout changes	Apex can change prices, rules or payout timing	Diversify into the personal account; keep fees a small share of payouts
Operational failures	Disconnects, rejected orders, PC sleep (already seen in week 1)	One-account shakedown week, error log, always-on machine, weekly report checks
Personal capital at risk	Drawdowns in the personal account are real money	Start with a starter set at ~$11k; climb the capital ladder only as the balance reaches each row; step down after a 20% drawdown
Event concentration	The CL fade earns ~85% of its profit on oil-news weekends	Small position (2 MCL); expected quiet stretches; watchlist review after each event

8. Immediate next steps

When	Action
Sun 10/25, after 17:00 CT	Apex Account Check indicator on both charts (step 1 of automatic cushion sizing)
~Mon 10/27	Add account #3 as a 150K No-Activation ($249), with its own chart set and 150K settings
Mon 10/26 on	Forward log starts (FC 2B, S47 v2, Kusho v9, S30): paper results at each Friday review
Before a 150K funded account	MultiCharts export of Dual Thrust v4 for the trade-by-trade check
Every week	Export MultiCharts reports to the live/ folder for the live-vs-backtest check
~Mid-December	Phase-1 gate decision: scale with 150K No-Activation, or review
~Feb 2027	First payouts expected; open the personal account (~$10k) from them

Appendix: account settings

Account	Settings
50K evaluation	Vault Break 8 MNQ; Overnight Bias ADX30 risk $1,100; Bridge Monday 2 MNQ; Expiration Open Short risk $500
50K funded	Vault Break 2 MNQ (1 on flagged days); Overnight Bias ML risk $400; Monday Long 1; Expiration Open Short $700; Late-Day Flow 2; NFP Fade $500; Bridge Monday 1; CL fade 2 MCL; ES MOC Follow 2 MES; Relative Strength longs 1. Full size once the cushion is $1,500, scaled down to half below
150K evaluation	Evaluation set x 2.5: Vault Break 20 MNQ; Overnight Bias ADX30 $2,750; Bridge Monday 5; Expiration Open Short $1,250
150K funded	Funded set x 1.5: Vault Break 3 / 1; Overnight Bias ML $600; Monday Long 1; Expiration Open Short $1,050; Late-Day Flow 3; NFP Fade $750; Bridge Monday 1; CL fade 3 MCL; ES MOC 3 MES; Relative Strength both sides 1; Dual Thrust 2 (1 below the cushion). Full size from a $3,000 cushion
Personal	17 pieces at 1 micro each at the ~$35.6k row (core of 16 at ~$26.2k), sized by the section-4 ladder; pieces and codes in personal_strategies/PORTFOLIO.md

Disclaimer: all figures are historical backtests and simulations using Apex's published rules as of October 2026. They are estimates, not guarantees; futures trading involves substantial risk of loss.